

1 Introduction

This document provides supporting information for Office for National Statistics (ONS) mortality statistics.

Publication dates for statistical releases are announced on the [GOV.UK release calendar](#). Statistical bulletins are published alongside releases and provide commentary on main findings.

The registration of life events (births, deaths, marriages and civil partnerships) is a service carried out by the Local Registration Service in partnership with the General Register Office (GRO) in Southport. GRO has been part of the Identity and Passport Service since 1 April 2008.

1.1 Symbols and conventions

In ONS mortality outputs published from July 2014 onwards symbols used are:

- : denotes not available
- z denotes not applicable
- 0 denotes nil
- c confidential
- u low reliability

Rates are not calculated where there are fewer than 3 deaths in a cell, denoted by (u). It is ONS practice not to calculate rates where there are fewer than 3 deaths in a cell, as rates based on such low numbers are susceptible to inaccurate interpretation.

Rates in tables calculated from fewer than 20 deaths are denoted by (u) as a warning to the user that their reliability as a measure may be affected by the small number of events.

In ONS mortality outputs published prior to July 2014 symbols used were:

- .. denotes not available
- : denotes not appropriate/not applicable
- denotes nil
- * suppressed to protect confidentiality

Also prior to July 2014:

- Rates were not calculated where there were fewer than 3 deaths in a cell, denoted by (:). It is ONS practice not to calculate rates where there are fewer than 3 deaths in a cell, as rates based on such low numbers are susceptible to inaccurate interpretation.
- Rates in tables calculated from fewer than 20 deaths were distinguished by italic type as a warning to the user that their reliability as a measure may be affected by the small number of events.

The new set of symbols used are being implemented across ONS outputs in order to improve harmonisation and consistency and facilitate understanding of data and comparability. For further information please refer to <https://gss.civilservice.gov.uk/statistics/a-z-of-policies-and-guidance/guidance-use-data-markers/>

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However, such deaths are excluded from any sub-division of England and Wales and presented separately in area tables (usual residence outside England and Wales)

- **age** is derived from the date of birth and from the date of death supplied by the informant, except after inquest, where the coroner supplies this information
- **sex** is as given by the informant (or coroner)
- **marital status** is supplied by the informant in confidence, under the Population (Statistics) Acts, and is not entered in the public register
- **place of occurrence** is given by the informant, except after inquest. This may be a hospital or some other establishment, in which case a unique code is assigned to it by the registrar. These codes are then classified by ONS to give the type of establishment. The place of occurrence could also be the deceased's own home, or elsewhere – possibly another private residence or not in a building. These deaths are summarised as “home” or “elsewhere” respectively – Section 2.5 provides further information
- **years of life lost** denote the number of years lost due to death at a “premature” age. The assumption is made here that there are suitable cut-off ages from which the age at death is subtracted. **Years of working life lost** are the number of years lost if death takes place before the end of the assumed working life; this is conventionally taken as 65. Section 2.21 provides more information
- the **underlying cause of death** is selected from the medical condition or conditions mentioned on the MCCD or on the coroner's certificate. More information can be found in Section 2.12

1.3 Publications

The [ONS website](#) provides a comprehensive source of freely available statistics on life events and other ONS products.

England and Wales:

To meet user needs, very timely but provisional counts of death registrations are published as follows:

- [Provisional counts of weekly death registrations](#) by age-sex group and region for England and Wales (published 11 days after the week ends)
- [Provisional counts of monthly death registrations](#) by local authorities in England and Wales (published on the fourth Tuesday of the following month)

Provisional figures have not been subject to the full quality assurance process. Figures remain provisional until they are updated to final figures following the publication of final annual statistics

Annual mortality statistics (based on deaths registered in a calendar year) are published in 3 separate packages to enable the timely release of statistics:

- the [first release](#) (Death registration summary tables) provides the main death registration statistics for the reference year

The [ONS policy on protecting confidentiality in birth and death statistics](#) is available on the ONS website. This guidance was revised in January 2014.

1.2 Information collected at death registration

The information used in mortality statistics is based on the details collected when deaths are certified and registered. Most deaths are certified by a medical practitioner, using the Medical Certificate of Cause of Death (MCCD) shown in [Annex A](#). This certificate is taken to a registrar of births and deaths by a person known as an informant – usually a near relative of the deceased.

Deaths should be registered within 5 days of the date of death, although there are a number of situations when the registration of a death will be delayed, as described fully in Section 2.6.

In certain cases deaths are referred to, and sometimes then investigated by, a coroner. The coroner sends information to the registrar, and this is used instead of that on the MCCD to register the death. In some cases additional information provided on Part B of the coroner's certificate ([Annex C](#)) is forwarded to ONS by the registrar. Accordingly, the information used in ONS mortality statistics normally comes from 1 of 4 sources.

1. details supplied by the **doctor** when certifying a death, for example, whether the body was seen after death, cause of death, when the deceased was last seen alive, whether a post-mortem was carried out.
2. details supplied by the **informant** to the registrar, for example, occupation of deceased, sex, usual address, date and place of birth, marital status, date of death, place of death.
3. details supplied by a **coroner** to the registrar following investigation, for example, cause of death (following post-mortem), place of accident (following inquest). In the case of deaths certified after inquest, the coroner supplies the registrar with all the particulars that would have been supplied by the informant.
4. details derived from information supplied by one or other of the above, for example, calculated age of deceased, interval since last seen alive, coded cause of death, coded occupation.

Details are also supplied by the **informant** on the spouse of the deceased (only if the deceased is either married or civil partnered), for example name, date of birth, occupation and employment status. If these details are supplied by the **coroner** rather than the informant then occupation and employment status will not be supplied.

Mortality data used and produced by ONS are summarised below:

- **death registrations** refer to the number of deaths registered in a period (see Section 2.2)
- **usual residence of deceased** is supplied by the informant and is the place where the deceased was normally resident (see Section 2.4). Deaths occurring in England and Wales of those usually resident outside England and Wales are included in total figures.

The population estimates used are the most up-to-date when rates are produced. The specific population estimates used to calculate rates are detailed alongside published tables. Sometimes it is necessary to revise mortality rates following population estimate revisions. Any revisions to mortality rates are footnoted on tables. Further information on [population estimates](#), and their methodology, can be found on the ONS website.

2.2 Occurrences and registrations and the standard dataset

Up to 1992, publications gave numbers of deaths registered in the period concerned. From 1993 to 2005, the figures in annual reference volumes relate to the number of deaths that occurred in the reference period. From 2006 onwards, all tables in Series DR are based on deaths registered in a calendar period. More details on these changes can be found in the publication [Mortality Statistics: Deaths Registered in 2006](#) (ONS, 2008).

Although the majority of mortality publications are now based on registrations, ONS continue to take an annual extract of death occurrences in the autumn following the data year, which is used for seasonal analysis of mortality data and several infant mortality outputs.

The numbers of registrations for a year which actually occurred in previous years are shown in Table 1 below.

**Table 1: Number of deaths that were registered and occurred in each calendar year
England and Wales, 2001 to 2014**

Annual Dataset Year for registrations	Number of registrations	Number registered which occurred in that year	Percentage of those registered that occurred in that year	Number registered which occurred in previous years	Percentage of those registered that occurred in previous years
2014	501,424	477,752	95.3	23,672	4.7
2013	506,790	482,658	95.2	24,132	4.8
2012	499,331	478,733	95.9	20,598	4.1
2011	484,367	463,450	95.7	20,917	4.3
2010	493,242	473,661	96.0	19,581	4.0
2009	491,348	471,113	95.9	20,235	4.1
2008	509,090	488,764	96.0	20,326	4.0
2007	504,052	485,068	96.2	18,984	3.8
2006	502,600	485,202	96.5	17,398	3.5
2005	512,993	497,603	97.0	15,390	3.0
2004	514,250	499,081	97.1	15,169	2.9
2003	539,151	524,827	97.3	14,324	2.7
2002	535,356	520,849	97.3	14,507	2.7
2001	532,498	517,010	97.1	15,488	2.9

Source: Office for National Statistics

Of the 501,424 deaths registered in 2014, 477,752 occurred in 2014, 21,474 occurred in 2013, 1,655 occurred in 2012 and 543 occurred prior to 2012.

Although the majority of mortality publications will be based on registrations, ONS will continue to take an annual extract of death occurrences in the autumn following the data year, which will therefore be available for seasonal analysis of mortality data and for infant

- [Series DR](#) provides detailed death registration statistics for the reference year by underlying cause of death (4 digit) classified using the [Tenth Revision of the International Classification of Diseases and Related Health Problems \(ICD-10\)](#).
- [Mortality statistics: area of usual residence](#) provides death registration statistics by area of usual residence (down to local authority level).

ONS also publishes more detailed annual mortality statistics in the following releases:

- [20th Century mortality files](#)
- [21st Century mortality files](#)
- [Deaths involving Clostridium difficile](#) (Wales only from 2013 data year onwards)
- [Deaths involving MRSA](#) (Wales only from 2013 data year onwards)
- [Deaths related to drug poisoning](#)
- [Alcohol-related deaths in the UK](#)
- [Suicides in the UK](#)
- [Avoidable mortality](#)
- [Excess winter mortality](#)

From 1974 to 2005, mortality statistics were published in the annual reference volumes, [DH1](#), [DH2](#) and [DH4](#). From 1993 to 2006, figures were based on deaths occurring annually in England and Wales. Prior to 1993, figures were based on deaths registered in England and Wales in the reference year. In 2006, these 3 volumes were replaced by a single publication, Mortality statistics: [Deaths registered in England and Wales \(Series DR\)](#) based on deaths registered in a reference year.

The annual reference volume [Child mortality statistics](#) (formerly [DH3](#)) contains data on stillbirths, infant deaths and childhood deaths. It includes figures on infant deaths linked to their corresponding birth records.

International, UK and constituent countries: The annual time series data table in the [Vital statistics: population and health reference tables](#) provides mortality statistics for the UK and its constituent countries with some measures available back to 1838. This release also provides an international comparison of the crude death rate.

Scotland: in the [Vital Events Reference Tables for Scotland](#).

Northern Ireland: in the [Annual Report of the Registrar General for Northern Ireland](#).

A summary of mortality statistics data also appear in the World Health Organization [World Health Statistics Annual](#) and [World Health Report](#).

2 Notes and definitions

2.1 Base populations

The population estimates used to calculate mortality rates are mid-year estimates of the resident population of England and Wales based on the Census of Population. ONS mid-year population estimates are updated figures using the most recent Census, allowing for births, deaths, net migration and ageing of the population.

jókst eftir langan tíma svo fólk í Gotlandi það mikið að landið gat ekki öllum veitt fæði. Þá létu þeir fara burt af landi þriðja hvern þegn, og allt máttu þau eiga og með sér burt hafa sem ofanjarðar áttu.

Translation:

This Thielvar had a son called Hafthi. And Hafthi's wife was called Hvitstjarna. Those two were the first to settle on Gotland. When they slept on the island for the first night, she dreamed that three snakes lay in her lap, and she thought they were sliding off her lap. She told this to Hafthi. He interpreted her dream and said: "Everything is bound with bangles, this island will be inhabited, and you will bear three sons." Although, they were not yet born, he named them Guti, who would own the island, Graip and Gunfjaun. The sons divided the island into three regions, and Graip, who was the eldest, took the north, Guti the middle, and Gunfjaun, who was the youngest, took the southern third. After a long time, their descendants became so numerous that the island could not support all of them. They drew lots and every third islander had to leave. They could keep everything they owned but the land.

References

- Nationalencyklopedin
 - Christine Peel. "Guta Saga - The History of the Gotlanders," *Viking Society for Northern Research Text Series*. Vol. XII. Viking Society for Northern Research, University College of London (1999).
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This page was last edited on 29 August 2017, at 19:15.

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gutland aigha graipr al annar haita Oc gunfiaun þriþi. þair sciptu siþan gutlandi i þria þriþiunga. So at graipr þann elzti laut norþasta þriþiung oc guti miþal þriþiung En gunfiaun þann yngsti laut sunnarsta. siþan af þissum þrim aucapis fulc j gutlandi so mikit um langan tima at land elptj þaim ai alla fyþa þa lutaþu þair bort af landi huert þriþia þiaup so at alt sculdu þair aiga oc miþ sir bort hafa sum þair vfan iorþar attu.

Standardised Old Gutnish:

Þissi Þieluar hafþi ann sun sum hit Hafþi. En Hafþa kuna hit Huita Stierna. Þaun tu bygðu fyrsti a Gutlandi. Fyrstu nat sum þaun saman suafu þa droymdi henni draumbr. So sum þrir ormar varin slungnir saman i barmi hennar ok þytti henni sum þair skriþin yr barmi hennar. Þinna draum segþi han firi Hafþa, bonda sinum. Hann riap draum þinna so: Alt ir baugum bundit, bo land al þitta varþa ok faum þria syni aiga. Þaim gaf hann namn allum ofydum. Guti al Gutland aiga, Graipr al annar haita ok Gunfiaun þriþi. Þair skiptu siþan Gutlandi i þria þriþiunga so at Graipr þann eldsti laut norþasta þriþiung ok Guti miþal þriþiung en Gunfiaun þann yngsti laut sunnarasta. Siþan af þissum þrim aukapis fulk i Gutlandi so mikit um langan tima at land elpti þaim ai alla fyþa. Þa lutaþu þair bort af landi huert þriþia þiaup so at alt skuldu þair aiga ok miþ sir bort hafa sum þair ufan iorþar attu.

Employing normalised Old Norse orthography:

Þissi Þjelvar hafði ann sun sum hit Hafði. En Hafða kuna hit Hvítastjerna. Þaun tú byggðu fyrsti á Gutlandi. Fyrstu nátt sum þaun saman sváfu þá droymdi henni draumr; só sum þrir ormar varin slungnir saman í barmi hennar, ok þýtti henni sum þair skriðin yr barmi hennar. Þinna draum segði han firi Hafða bónda sínum. Hann raið draum þinna só: "Alt ir baugum bundit, bóland al þitta varða uk fáum þría syni aiga." Þaim gaf hann namn, allum ófýddum; Guti, al Gutland aiga; Graipr, al annar haita; ok Gunnfjaun þriði. Þair skiptu síðan Gutlandi í þría þriðjunga, só at Graipr þann eldsti laut norðasta þriðjung, ok Guti miðal þriðjung, en Gunnfjaun þann yngsti laut sunnarsta. Síðan, af þissum þrim aukaðis fulk í Gutlandi sum mikit um langan tíma at land elpti þaim ai alla fýða. Þá lutaðu þair bort af landi hvert þriðja þjauð só at alt skuldu þair aiga ok mið sír bort hafa sum þair ufan jorðar áttu.

Translation: in Icelandic:

Son hann Þjálfi átti sem hét Hafði. Og kona Hafða hét Hvítastjarna. Þau tvö byggðu fyrst manna á Gotlandi. Fyrstu nótt sem þau þar saman sváfu þá dreymdi hana draum; sá hún þrjá orma vafðir saman í barmi hennar, og þótti henni sem þeir skriða niður barm hennar. Þennan draum sagði hún Hafða bónda sínum. Hann réð draum þann svo: "Allt er baugum bundið og verður allt land þitt búið og munum við þrjá syni eiga." Þeim gaf hann nöfn ófæddum, Goti sem Gotland á að eiga; Greipur sem annar hét; og Gunnfjón sá þriðji. Þeir skiptu síðan Gotlandi í þrjá þriðjunga, þá fékk Greipur sá elsti norður þriðjunginn, og Goti miðju þriðjunginn, en Gunnfjón sá yngsti fékk suður þriðjunginn. Seinna, af þessum þremur

Old Gutnish

Old Gutnish was the dialect of Old Norse that was spoken on the Baltic island of Gotland. It shows sufficient differences from the Old West Norse and Old East Norse dialects that it is considered to be a separate branch. Gutnish is still spoken in some parts of Gotland and on the adjoining island of Fårö.

The root *Gut* is identical to *Goth*, and it is often remarked that the language has similarities with the Gothic language. These similarities have led scholars such as Elias Wessén and Dietrich Hofmann to suggest that it is most closely related to Gothic. The best known example of such a similarity is that Gothic and Gutnish called both adult and young sheep *lamb*.

The Old Norse diphthong *au* (e.g. *auga* "eye") remained in Old Gutnish and Old West Norse, while in Old East Norse – except for peripheral dialects – it evolved into the monophthong *ó*, i.e. a long version of *ø*. Likewise the diphthong *ai* in *bain* (bone) remained in Old Gutnish while it in Old West Norse became *ei* as in *bein* and in Old East Norse it became *é* (*bén*). Whereas Old West Norse had the *ey* diphthong and Old East Norse evolved the monophthong *ø*) Old Gutnish had *oy*.

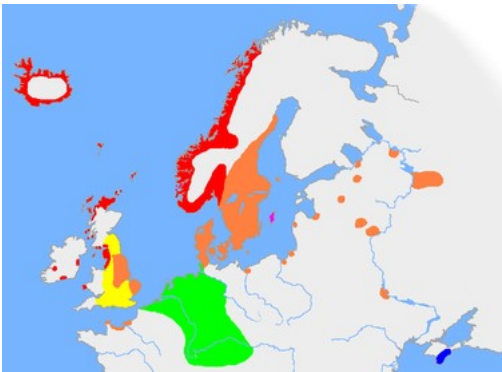
Proto-Germanic	Old Gutnish	Old West Norse	Old East Norse
* <i>augô</i> (eye)	<i>auga</i>	<i>auga</i>	<i>auga</i> > <i>øga</i>
* <i>bainą</i> (bone)	<i>bain</i>	<i>bein</i>	<i>bæin</i> > <i>bén</i>
* <i>hauzijaną</i> (to hear)	<i>hoyra</i>	<i>heyra</i>	<i>høyra</i> > <i>hóra</i>

Most of the corpus of Old Gutnish is found in the Gutasaga from the 13th century.

Language sample

Citation:

Þissi þieluar hafði ann sun sum hit hafði. En hafða cuna hit huita stierna þaun tu bygðu fyrsti agutlandi fyrstu nat sum þaun saman suafu þa droymdi hennj draumbr. So sum þrir ormar warin slungnir saman j barmj hennar Oc þytti hennj sum þair scriþin yr barmi hennar. Þinna draum segði han firi hasða bonda sinum hann riap dravm þinna so. Alt ir baugum bundit bo land al þitta warða oc faum þria syni aiga. þaim gaf hann namn allum o fydum. guti al



The approximate extent of Old Norse and related languages in the early 10th century:

- ☐ Old West Norse dialect
- ☐ Old East Norse dialect
- ☐ Old Gutnish
- ☐ Old English
- ☐ Crimean Gothic
- ☐ Other Germanic languages with which Old Norse still retained some mutual intelligibility